

Sunday, 16 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

26° 20°

BIRMINGHAM

Light drizzle

23° 14°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

20° 15°

GLASGOW

Heavy drizzle

18° 13°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 A powerful magnitude 7.7 earthquake has tragically killed at least 47 people in Indonesia.**
The quake struck the island of Flores, in eastern Indonesia, on Friday. Search and rescue operations are now underway to find survivors.
DISASTER · WORLD
- 2 The military has been called in to help emergency services battle wildfires across parts of the UK.**
Police are investigating a "deliberate fire" near Porth, with four 14-year-old boys arrested. Firefighters are still working to control blazes across the West Midlands and the New Forest.
ENVIRONMENT · UK
- 3 Two people have sadly died after a light aircraft crashed in Wales.**
The plane, which was travelling from England, failed to arrive at Caernarfon Airport as scheduled on Friday. Investigations are now underway.
ACCIDENT · UK
- 4 A derailed train in Essex has caused significant travel chaos for passengers.**
More than 60 patients were checked over by ambulance crews at the scene, but thankfully all were discharged. Services remain disrupted as clean-up operations continue.
TRANSPORT · UK
- 5 The death of Professor Arday will send shockwaves through academia, with barely 1% of UK professors being black.**
Education Editor Branwen Jeffreys highlights that Professor Arday was part of a small, visible minority. His passing is expected to spark further discussions on diversity within universities.
EDUCATION · UK

What's coming up

1 **Glastonbury organiser Emily Eavis has dismissed rumours that Madonna will headline the festival in 2027.**

Eavis confirmed that the festival has already booked its headliners for that year. However, she was clear the Queen of Pop is "definitely not" among them.

ON AIR – Who do you think has been booked for Glastonbury 2027?

MUSIC · FUTURE

2 **Travis Kelce has shared the first details about his wedding to Taylor Swift, calling it the 'best night of my life'.**

Kelce referred to Swift as his "wife" for the first time in comments, revealing it was a "childhood dream" to marry at Madison Square Garden. Fans are eagerly awaiting more details.

ON AIR – What's your dream wedding venue?

CELEBRITY · RECENT

3 **Actress Bella Ramsey says she wishes she had been a more rebellious teenager.**

Ramsey stars in a new film about a cancer survivor who finds friendship and freedom at "chemo camp". She reflected on her own youth and the desire for more rebellion.

ON AIR – Do you have any regrets about your teenage years?

FILM · UPCOMING

4 **A musician is set to go ahead with her Edinburgh Fringe shows despite her treasured instruments being stolen.**

Sachie Mikawa had cancelled her best-selling nights after her trumpet and vintage melodica went missing. She's now determined to perform, showing incredible resilience.

ON AIR – What's the most valuable thing you've ever had stolen?

THEATRE · UPCOMING

5 **Eurovision organisers are reportedly proposing new rules to reduce political voting in the contest.**

They suggest politically motivated voting is "persistent" and "deeply worrying" for the competition's integrity. The aim is to ensure the focus remains on the music.

ON AIR – Do you think political voting is a problem at Eurovision?

MUSIC · FUTURE

On the schedule

- 1 **Ireland's Kate O'Connor is leading the heptathlon at the European Athletics Championships in Birmingham.**
She's in pole position for gold with just the 800m remaining. Unfortunately, Great Britain's Katarina Johnson-Thompson is now out of contention for a medal.

ON AIR – Who are you backing for gold in the women's 800m final?
ATHLETICS · UK

- 2 **Germany's Owen Ansah has won 200m gold at the European Athletics Championships.**
He finished in an impressive 19.95 seconds, with Great Britain's Zharnel Hughes taking home the silver medal. It was a thrilling race for the Birmingham crowd.

ON AIR – What's been your favourite moment from the European Athletics Championships so far?
ATHLETICS · UK

- 3 **Former Monaco head coach Sebastien Pocognoli is the frontrunner to become the new Scotland boss.**
The Scottish FA has identified Pocognoli as their prime candidate to replace Steve Clarke. Fans will be eager to see if a deal can be struck.

ON AIR – Do you think Pocognoli is the right choice for Scotland?
FOOTBALL · UK

- 4 **Norway's Karsten Warholm has become a four-time European 400m hurdles champion.**
He comfortably won the men's 400m hurdles, setting a championship record in the process. It's a truly dominant performance from the Norwegian star.

ON AIR – Which athlete has impressed you most at the European Championships?
ATHLETICS · UK

- 5 **Paul Walter was the unlikely star as Manchester Super Giants reached The Hundred final.**
The all-rounder smashed 80 off just 46 balls to comfortably beat Sunrisers Leeds. It was a fantastic performance to secure their spot in the men's final.

ON AIR – Who are you hoping wins The Hundred final?
CRICKET · UK

Quick hits

- 1 New research suggests that spending time looking at 'blue spaces' like rivers or the sea can significantly improve mood.**
Scientists found that even short periods observing natural bodies of water led to noticeable reductions in stress and feelings of greater calm. It seems a trip to the coast or a riverside walk truly does do us good!
- 2 The charming tradition of 'pub quizzes' is experiencing a wonderful resurgence across the UK.**
More and more locals are gathering for friendly battles of wits, enjoying the camaraderie and the challenge of general knowledge questions. It's a great way to socialise and keep those brain cells buzzing.
- 3 A delightful trend for 'vintage-style board games' is captivating families and friends.**
People are rediscovering the joy of unplugged entertainment, with classic games featuring beautiful artwork and simple, engaging rules becoming highly sought after. It's perfect for a rainy afternoon.
- 4 The simple pleasure of 'baking your own bread' is making a heartwarming comeback.**
From rustic sourdoughs to simple loaves, more home bakers are enjoying the therapeutic process and the unbeatable aroma of freshly baked bread. Nothing beats a warm slice with butter!
- 5 Community 'seed-swapping events' are flourishing, connecting gardeners and fostering biodiversity.**
Amateur horticulturalists are sharing their surplus seeds, from rare flowers to heirloom vegetables, promoting local plant varieties and encouraging sustainable gardening practices. It's a lovely way to meet fellow green-fingered enthusiasts.
- 6 A quirky new trend for 'colour-coded bookshelves' is sweeping through interior design circles.**
Book lovers are arranging their collections by the colour of the spine, creating vibrant visual displays that are both artistic and surprisingly satisfying. It certainly makes a statement!
- 7 New research highlights the benefits of 'short bursts of brisk walking' for overall health.**
Even just 10-minute walks spread throughout the day can significantly improve cardiovascular health and boost energy levels. It's a simple way to stay active, even on busy days.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to figure out if our socks match, even if the light is a bit dim?

ANSWER: HOLDING THEM UP TO OUR NOSE FOR A QUICK SNIFF TEST!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh cup of tea. What is it?

ANSWER: STIRRING IT AN EXACT NUMBER OF TIMES, EVERY SINGLE TIME!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular song' comes on the radio, and it just instantly transports you back to a specific moment or memory?

What's that song for you, and what memory does it bring back? Tell us about the music that truly takes you back in time!

- We all have those 'little everyday sounds' that are uniquely British, don't we, that just feel like home?

What's a quintessential British sound that always makes you smile or feel nostalgic? Maybe it's a particular bird song, or a certain kind of traffic noise?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** Did you know that the United Kingdom once had a 'Ministry of Information' during World War II, which employed authors like George Orwell and J.R.R. Tolkien?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that in the 18th century, a London baker invented a special 'glow-in-the-dark' bread, believing it would help people navigate their kitchens during power cuts?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£32 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£32 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The distinctive red 'phone boxes' we see across the UK were designed by Sir Giles Gilbert Scott, who also designed Battersea Power Station.
- The world's first 'postage stamp', the Penny Black, was issued in the United Kingdom in 1840.
- A group of 'badgers' is called a cete.
- The longest river in the UK is the River Severn, which runs for approximately 220 miles.
- Big Ben is actually the nickname for the Great Bell of the clock at the north end of the Palace of Westminster, not the clock tower itself.
- The first 'fish and chip shop' in the UK is believed to have opened in London in the 1860s.
- The 'Changing of the Guard' ceremony at Buckingham Palace typically lasts about 45 minutes.
- The 'Queen's official portrait' has appeared on British stamps since 1953.

On this day

Day 228 of the year, 137 days left in 2026. Today Bennington Battle Day (Vermont, United States); Children's Day (Paraguay); Christian feast day: Ana Petra Pérez Florido; Christian feast day: Armel (Armagillus). Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1962 — Steve Carell, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1970 — Seth Peterson, American actor
- 1963 — Christine Cavanaugh, American voice artist (died 2014)
- 1942 — Barbara George, American R&B singer-songwriter (died 2006)
- 1979 — Paul Gallacher, Scottish footballer
- 1946 — Lesley Ann Warren, American actress
- 1958 — Angela Bassett, American actress
- 1945 — Bob Balaban, American actor, director, and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1975 — Australian Prime Minister Gough Whitlam symbolically hands over land to the Gurindji people after the eight-year Wave Hill walk-off, a landmark event in the history of Indigenous land rights in Australia, commemorated in a 1991 song by Paul Kelly and an annual celebration.
- 1945 — The National Representatives' Congress, the precursor of the current National Assembly of Vietnam, convenes in Sơn Dương.
- 1954 — The first issue of Sports Illustrated is published.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1975 — Australian Prime Minister Gough Whitlam symbolically hands over land to the Gurindji people after the eight-year Wave Hill walk-off, a landmark event in the history of Indigenous land rights in Australia, commemorated in a 1991 song by Paul Kelly and an annual celebration.
- 2013 — The ferry St. Thomas Aquinas collides with a cargo ship and sinks at Cebu, Philippines, killing 61 people with 59 others missing.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1964 — Vietnam War: A coup d'état replaces Dương Văn Minh with General Nguyễn Khánh as President of South Vietnam. A new constitution is established with aid from the U.S. Embassy.

- 1946 — The All Hyderabad Trade Union Congress is founded in Secunderabad.
- 1945 — The National Representatives' Congress, the precursor of the current National Assembly of Vietnam, convenes in Sơn Dương.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 229 of the year, 136 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Saint Beatrice of Silva; Christian feast day: Saint Clare of Montefalco; Christian feast day: Elias of Enna; Christian feast day: Saint Hyacinth of Poland. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1943 — Dave "Snaker" Ray, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2002)
- 1967 — David Conrad, American actor
- 1968 — Helen McCrory, English actress (died 2021)
- 1988 — Joyner Lucas, American rapper
- 1953 — Kevin Rowland, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1949 — Sib Hashian, American rock drummer (died 2017)
- 1946 — Martha Coolidge, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1962 — Gilby Clarke, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1962 — Peter Fechter is shot and bleeds to death while trying to cross the new Berlin Wall.
- 1988 — President of Pakistan Muhammad Zia-ul-Haq and U.S. Ambassador Arnold Raphel are killed in a plane crash.
- 2008 — American swimmer Michael Phelps becomes the first person to win eight gold medals at one Olympic Games.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1960 — Aeroflot Flight 036 crashes in Soviet Ukraine, killing 34.
- 1988 — President of Pakistan Muhammad Zia-ul-Haq and U.S. Ambassador Arnold Raphel are killed in a plane crash.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

22–23

Belgian Grand Prix (F1)